

What I shipped today: the process I now own

2026-09-17

Today's job was to turn what's been living in my head into three documents other people can point at. From here, anyone building anything social at the company can go straight to these instead of asking me directly -- that's the actual point of writing them down.

1. The three documents

Document	What it settles
COMMENT_QUALITY_STANDARD_V2.md	The standing answer to "what does a good comment look like." Versioned (v2), dated, and it replaces the draft spec from August -- same rules, but now it says plainly which ones the code actually enforces today, not just which ones I originally wanted.
docs/REVIEW_SLA.md	How fast the queue should get cleared, how deep it's allowed to get before that's a real signal, and who to escalate to -- with an expected response time next to each name, not just a name.
docs/HANDOVER_NOTE.md	The stuff that's only in my head right now. Written as if I disappeared tomorrow and someone else had to pick this up cold.

2. The one real decision I made today

Writing the standard forced an actual choice I'd been letting slide: my original spec from August said comments should cap at 280 characters, but the code has shipped a 400-character cap this whole time and nothing bad has come of it. Rather than let the two documents keep quietly disagreeing, v2 adopts 400 as the real number -- the number already live, not the one I guessed at before I had data.

Two other gaps I did **not** quietly fix: the sentence-count rule still isn't enforced as a blocker, and the emoji/exclamation-mark thresholds are looser than what I originally wrote down. Both need new logic in the shared quality gate, which is Hemang's call, not something to slip in while writing documentation. Both are named as open items with his name on them and a review date, not buried.

What the handover note says out loud

- There's exactly one reviewer on this whole project right now, and it's me. No second approver has ever cleared an item.
- The Sep 15 live dry run -- 20 real items, a real account, Deep watching, Harshil's written sign-off -- still hasn't actually happened. Everything around it is ready; the session itself isn't run.

- Fixed today, in passing, while verifying the docs: the frontend/backend repo split on Sep 16 silently broke `run_golden_set.py`'s path to `docs/golden_set/` -- it was computing the path as if `scripts/` still lived at the repo root. Found it by actually running the command the quality doc tells people to run, not by reading the code.

Nothing above is committed or pushed yet -- same as always, tell me and I'll do it.